

LU CHEN



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Base Wuhan

Key Skills

Story-led

Communications

Designing narratives that humanize brands and build emotional resonance.

Cross-cultural Strategy

Translating global messaging into locally resonant stories across APAC markets.

Campaign Leadership

Leading and executing high-impact, multi-platform storytelling initiatives.

Social Media &

Community Growth

Experienced in digital campaigns, influencer partnerships, and audience analytics.

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cultural journalist turned communications strategist with 10+ years of experience shaping narratives across culture, travel, and technology. Skilled at turning insights into campaigns that connect people and places. Experienced in cross-cultural storytelling, content strategy, and social impact communication.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Co-Founder & Content Lead | "Chasing Butterflies with Wenhao"

Wuhan | Mar 2025 - Present

1. Founded and led a nature storytelling brand exploring biodiversity and travel culture.
2. Built and managed a multi-platform presence (rednote, WeChat, Douyin), achieving 5.8M+ impressions on single posts and reaching diverse outdoor communities.
3. Crafted brand voice and creative direction for collaborations with People's Posts and Telecommunications Press, National Geographic China, Douyin Science, and She's Jewelry.

Senior journalist | Sanlian Lifeweek Magazine

Beijing | Apr 2019 - Jun 2025

1. Collaborated on cultural and lifestyle travel features connecting people, culture, and place – including "The Geography of Li Bai, Xu Xiake, and Su Shi", cover stories on Sanxingdui and the Bronze Age along the Yangtze River, and experiential series on hiking and cycling across China.
2. Led multi-platform storytelling campaigns including "Fan Culture & Social Emotions" and "Back to Hogwarts", achieving tens of millions of impressions and nationwide discussion across WeChat, Weibo, and Bilibili.
3. Produced brand videos and podcasts to enhance engagement; collaborated with design, product, and PR teams to align messaging.
4. Mentored junior writers on improving narrative logic, editorial quality, and persuasive writing.

Editor | The Art Newspaper China

Shanghai | Sep 2017 - Nov 2018

1. Edited bilingual cultural features on global art, design, and technology, ensuring narrative clarity and consistency with the international edition.

Creative Collaboration

Adept at cross-functional teamwork with marketing, product, and design teams.

2. Participated in the annual Global Art Calendar project, coordinating content curation across Asia, Europe, and North America to highlight major exhibitions and art fairs.
3. Collaborated with global editorial teams to adapt and localize content for Chinese readers, strengthening cross-cultural communication.

Social Media Editor | Songguo Life (Sanlian Lifeweek)

Beijing | Nov 2016 - Jul 2017

1. Managed WeChat and Weibo accounts, growing followers from 10K → 120K (WeChat) and 40K → 80K (Weibo).
2. Built partnerships with 100+ media and KOLs, successfully onboarding nearly 50 to the Songguo platform.
3. Supported brand campaigns (SONOS, China Eastern Airlines Global Taste Tour, LIFE+ Talks), integrating online and offline engagement.

Media Officer | China Philanthropy Research Institute, Beijing Normal University

Beijing | Mar 2016 - Oct 2016

1. Managed new media operations, project reports, and campaign materials.
2. Contributed to major events including Children's Museum Night and the China-US Children's Education Forum, reaching a cumulative audience of 20M+.

Freelance Writer / Photographer / Designer

2013 - Present

1. Contributor for GQ, T Magazine China, Modern Weekly, ELLEMEN, Harper's Bazaar Art, and commercial clients such as Aranya Real Estate.
2. Photography projects covering portraits, events, and still life; taught local photography workshops.
3. Designed exhibition materials for Laoni Children's Museum and Wolverhampton Art Gallery, where I also conducted oral-history interviews and supported the *Wolverhampton Black Country Festival*.

EDUCATION

MSc in Museum Studies | 2013 - 2015 | University of Leicester, UK

- Thesis: How to Establish a Digital Business Model for Museums?(Distinction)

BEng in Digital Media Technology | 2009 - 2013 | Central China Normal University, China

- Led the university's Animation Society, organizing a city-wide original animation competition that engaged thousands of participants and sponsors; early experience in creative production and community building.